

Money for Nothing -- Dire Straits

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. Full board.

From *Brothers in Arms* (1985), ~120 BPM.

Mark Knopfler's guitar carries all the grit here -- that famous, heavily-processed riff tone. John Illsley's bass job is to stay punchy, clean, and driving underneath it, with just a hint of the glossy mid-80s sheen that's all over this record. Verses are narration-driven and groove-locked; the "money for nothin'" chorus hook opens things up a bit more.

CTL off = the driving verse groove. CTL on = the chorus hook.

GP-5 settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB.

NR -- Gate

- THRE: 15
- Always on. Low threshold -- this is a clean, punchy tone, nothing much to clean up.

PRE -- Micro Boost -- On CTL

- Gain: 50
- CTL off: bypassed (verse). CTL on: engaged (chorus).
- Verse groove carries itself under the narration-style vocal. Chorus gets a clean push to sit level with the full hook.

DST -- Off

- No drive. The guitar owns all the distortion in this song -- the bass needs to stay clean and out of its way.

AMP -- Foxy Bass (Vox AC-100)

- VOL: 68, Bass: 58, Treble: 58
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- A simpler, more direct bass amp voicing rather than a modern high-headroom design -- fits a mid-80s British rock record where the bass tone is straightforward and doesn't call attention to itself.

CAB -- User IR 4 (EBS410)

- VOL: 58
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- Accentuated high-mids with a boost around 2-3kHz -- `IRs/ir.md` flags this one specifically for clean tones that need to sit well in a mix, which is exactly this song's job: punchy and present without any grit to lean on.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2

- 50Hz: +2, 120Hz: +1, 400Hz: -2, 800Hz: +3, 4.5kHz: +3, VOL: 55
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- +3 at both 800Hz and 4.5kHz keeps this bright and present, matching the glossy, radio-friendly production of the record. -2 at 400Hz keeps it from getting boxy under all that upper-mid push.

MOD -- B-Chorus (Boss CEB-3)

- Depth: 20, Rate: 0.3Hz, VOL: 55
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- Very light touch -- just enough to add that glossy mid-80s sheen this whole record is soaked in, without ever reading as an obvious "chorus effect." This is the deliberate exception to leaving MOD off entirely: the era calls for it, so it's baked in throughout rather than saved for a CTL moment.

DLY -- Off

- Not used.

RVB -- Room -- On CTL

- Mix: 20, Decay: 30, Trail: On
- CTL off: bypassed (verse -- tight and dry). CTL on: engaged (chorus).
- A touch of room opens the tone up for the "money for nothin'" hook, matching the bigger, more anthemic feel of the chorus.

CAB IR -- EBS410 (Slot 4)

- EBS ProLine 410 with a 2" tweeter, confirmed loaded on User IR slot 4. Accentuated high-mids that sit well in a mix, particularly on clean tones -- the direct match for this song's punchy, present, ungritted bass job.
- Encoded directly into the `.prst` as a real, active CAB reference (`User IR 4`) -- no manual loading needed for this one.

CTL summary

- **CTL Off -- Verse.** The driving, narration-style groove. Dry, tight, punchy.
- **CTL On -- Chorus.** Boost and room reverb engage together for the "money for nothin' and chicks for free" hook.
- Engage CTL right as the chorus hits, back off returning to the verse groove.

Full pedalboard (signal chain order)

1. Flamma FS-08 Octave -- Bypassed

- Footswitch off. This groove doesn't call for any octave layering -- straightforward and direct.

2. Donner Ultimate Comp -- Engaged

- COMP: 50
- TONE: 60
- LEVEL: 60
- Mode: TREBLE
- Moderate compression keeps the groove punchy and consistent. TREBLE mode keeps pick/finger attack bright, matching the clean, present character this whole tone is built around.

3. Donner Stylish Fuzz -- Bypassed

- Footswitch off. No fuzz anywhere -- the guitar owns all the grit in this song, the bass stays clean.

4. Joyo Tidal Wave -- Engaged

- Drive: 15
- Blend: 30
- Presence: 60
- Level: 60
- Treble: 58
- Middle: 55
- Bass: 55
- Mid-Frequency: 1000Hz
- Bass-Shift: 80Hz
- Cab-Sim (DI out): Off
- Ground Lift: Off
- Used lightly here for a touch of preamp presence and EQ shaping rather than overdrive -- Drive stays low. Mid-Frequency at 1000Hz and Bass-Shift at 80Hz both push toward attack and articulation over body, matching this song's punchy, driving character.

5. Joyo Narcissus -- Bypassed

- Footswitch off. The GP-5's own B-Chorus already covers the subtle 80s sheen this patch wants -- running a second chorus source would push it from "gloss" into "obvious effect."

6. Valeton GP-5 -- see settings above.